

OVERVIEW OF NUTRITION COUNSELING

Abdullah Otayf, MS, RD
MNTR 604 - Counseling Behavior

Objectives

- ▶ Discuss the influence of counseling on the client.
- ▶ Describe some theories that influence the counselor
- ▶ Importance of Nutrition Counseling in the Nutrition

Care Process

- ▶ Identify the components of counseling skills
- ▶ Understand the diagram the counseling spectrum

Definition of Nutrition Counseling:

- ▶ Nutrition counseling is a combination of nutrition expertise and psychological skill delivered by a trained nutrition counselor who understands how to work within the current medical setting.
- ▶ It focuses on both foods and the nutrients contained within them, emphasizing our feelings as we experience eating.

Theories Influence Counselors

- ▶ 1. behavior modification
- ▶ 2. cognitive-behavioral theory (CBT)
- ▶ 3. social learning theory
- ▶ 4. standard behavioral therapy
- ▶ 5. transtheoretical model
- ▶ 6. person-centered therapy
- ▶ 7. theory of planned behavior
- ▶ 8. Gestalt therapy
- ▶ 9. family therapy
- ▶ 10. self-management approach
- ▶ 11. the health belief model
- ▶ 12. developmental skills training.

Behavior Modification

- ▶ Pavlov, et al., state that “People are born in a neutral state”. (Environment, consisting of significant others and experience shapes their behavior).
- Behavior is **modified** by using the *ABCs* of behavior:
 - **A** is the antecedent of behavior that triggers an act
 - **B** is the behavior itself
 - **C** is the consequence of that behavior
- ▶ A person who eats while watching TV would identify the antecedent of this behavior or the trigger as television watching with a bowl of candy nearby.
- ▶ The behavior then is the act of eating.
- ▶ The consequence is the weight gain associated with eating.

Behavior Modification(Contd)

- ▶ The goal in changing a behavior is to stop this chain of events by modifying components within the chain.
- ▶ For example, by eliminating the bowl of candy the chain of events would stop prior to the behavior of eating. The consequence of weight gain would be averted.

Cognitive Behavioral Therapy

- ▶ CBT focuses on the way one thinks about the action taken.
- ▶ Negative thoughts of failure may trigger unhealthy eating behaviors
- ▶ Help client restructure his/her internal monologue
- ▶ Client should avoid all-or-nothing concept of perfection
- ❖ For example, the client who says, “I might as well give up—I just ate that forbidden cake. What is the use in even trying?” This client might restructure his/her internal monologue by saying, “If I have one piece at this special event, that is fine. I will just stop with one slice. This can still be a positive experience.”

Social learning Theory

- ▶ Social learning theory builds on the idea of modeling.
- ▶ people learn through seeing someone model a positive behavior.
- ▶ In group counseling, one participant who is doing well might describe or model her experiences.
- ▶ By seeing how someone else handles a difficult situation, it becomes more feasible for a client to take on that experience and succeed.

Theory of Planned Behavior

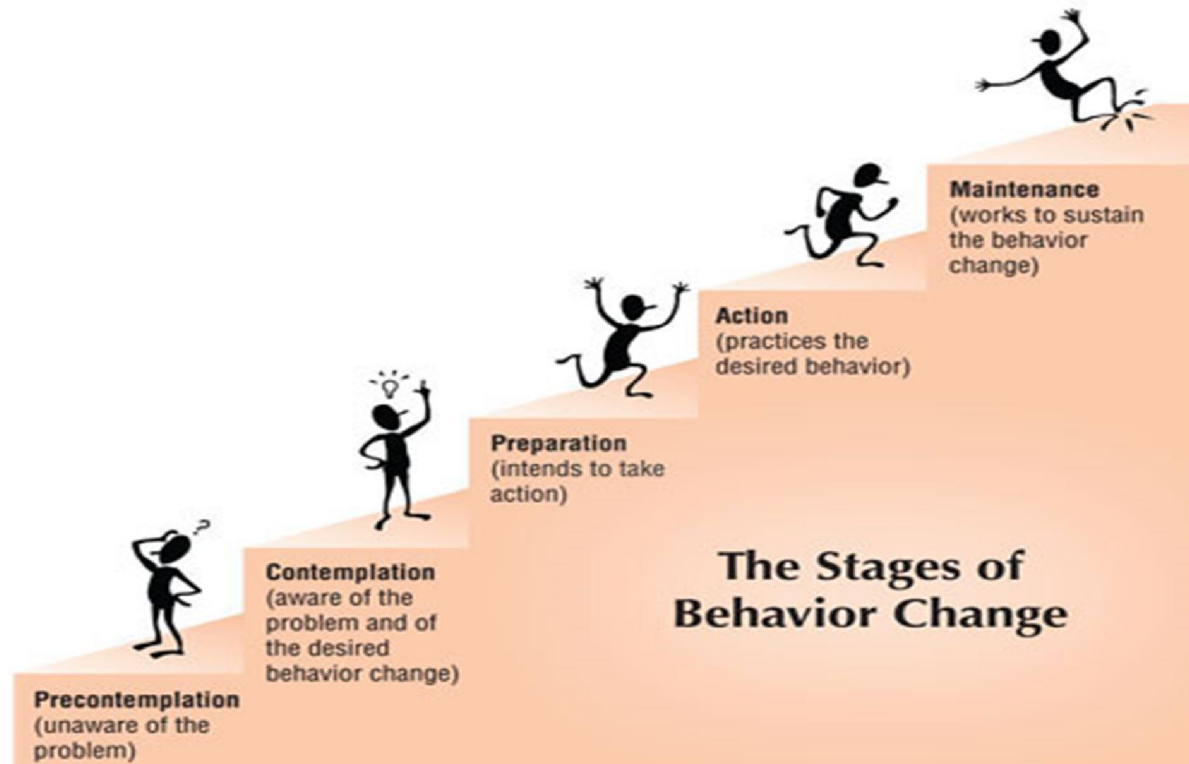
- ▶ Behavior is shaped by the beliefs and attitudes of a person.
- ▶ For example, the person who believes that he/she *can* make a dietary behavioral change (self-efficacy) will be more likely to achieve that change.

Family Therapy

- ▶ In family therapy, the family is considered a system of relationships that influence a client's behavior.
- ▶ The goal is to help individuals and families to change themselves and the systems within which they live.

Transtheoretical Model

- focuses on the concept of behavioral change and occurs in stages of motivation as clients move to a more healthful lifestyle.



Transtheoretical Model (TTM)

A client moves through stages of motivation to a more healthful lifestyle.

There are five stages:

- ▶ Precontemplation (**NO** intention of changing/unaware of problem)
- ▶ Contemplation (look at pros and cons of making change/aware of problem)
- ▶ Preparation (commitment to a behavioral change w/o plan of action)
- ▶ Action (actual positive behavior occurs)
- ▶ Maintenance (sustained behavioral change)

Health Belief Model

- ▶ Focuses on the individual's ability to envision success while moving toward better health by changing behavior.
- ▶ Two assumptions are involved:
- ▶ A person will adopt a behavior if failing to do so has consequences

that are a critical threat to lifestyle as it exists.

- ▶ Changing a behavior depends on a balance between barriers versus benefits to change.

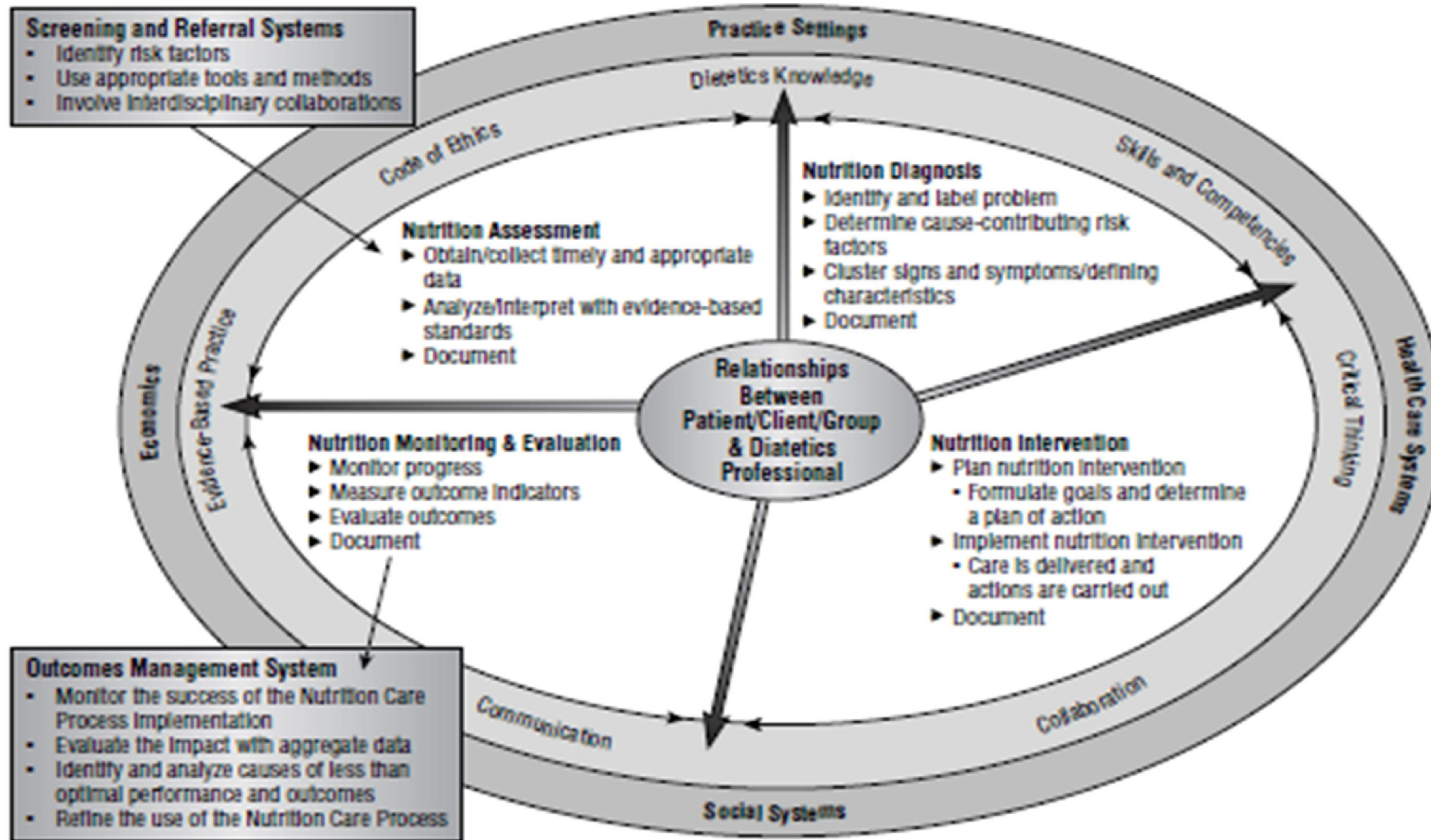
Health Belief Model (Contd)

- For example, a client decides to follow a diet low in saturated fat after a heart attack. He feels very vulnerable, and the consequences of not changing to healthier eating behaviors are very real. When he looks at the scale of pros and cons to changing dietary habits, the positive aspects of living a longer life outweigh the barriers of socializing with friends and eating food high in saturated fat.

Nutrition Counseling in the Nutrition Care Process

- ▶ The Nutrition Care Process is a systematic approach to providing high quality of nutritional care.
- ▶ The Nutrition Care Process consists of four steps:
 - ✓ Nutrition Assessment
 - ✓ Nutrition Diagnosis
 - ✓ Nutrition Intervention
 - ✓ Nutrition Monitoring/Evaluation
- ▶ Nutrition counseling sets the stage for dietary adherence in the “intervention” stage.

Nutrition Counseling in the Nutrition Care Process (Contd)



Nutrition Counseling in the Nutrition Care Process (Contd)

- ▶ Dietary adherence should be the ultimate goal of all nutrition counseling sessions.
- ▶ However, there are many deterrents to dietary adherence:
 - the restrictiveness of the dietary pattern
 - the required changes in lifestyle and behavior
 - the fact that symptom relief may not be noticeable or may be temporary
 - the interference of diet with family or personal habits
 - • other barriers:
 1. cost
 2. access to proper foods
 3. effort necessary for food preparation.

Nutrition Counseling in the Nutrition Care Process (Contd)

Strategies or techniques that increase dietary adherence:

- ▶ Use strategies that influence client behavior
- ▶ Involve clients more during the session
- ▶ Use social supports inside and outside healthcare setting
- ▶ Provide training and skills in addition to information
- ▶ Pay attention to follow-up, monitoring and reinforcement
- ▶ Show empathy and interest

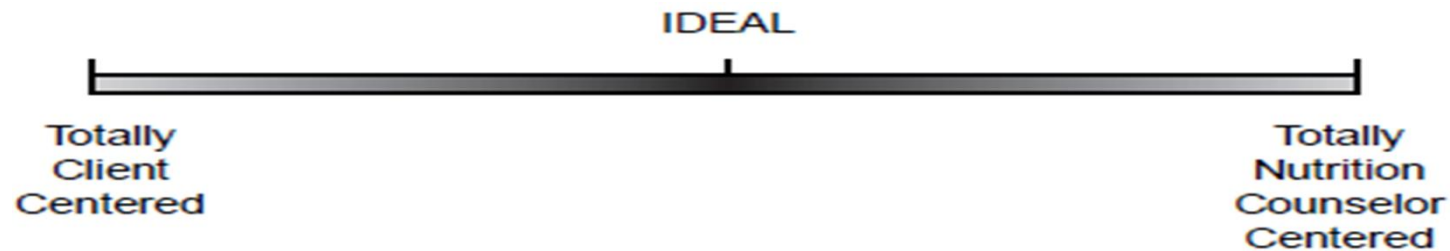
Counseling Skills

Communication Skills

- ▶ Basic to all counseling is knowledge of communication skills.
- ▶ Without these skills, treatment cannot and will not take place.
- ▶ Once clinicians have acquired this foundation, they then can learn various counseling skills to aid clients in achieving dietary goals.
- ▶ These skills involve:
 - Nutrition Assessment
 - Nutrition diagnosis
 - Nutrition Intervention
 - Monitoring and evaluation

Nutrition Counseling Spectrum

- ▶ Total client centered (counseling totally dominated by client requests/talk)
 - ▶ Totally nutrition counselor centered (counselor provides information w/o listening to client concerns)
 - ▶ Ideal (mix of client and counselor interaction)
- ✓ “ideal mix” increases self-management and likely ensures success in changing dietary behavior



References

- ▶ Snetselaar, L. G. (2009). *Nutrition counseling skills for the nutrition care process*. Sudbury, Mass: Jones and Bartlett.